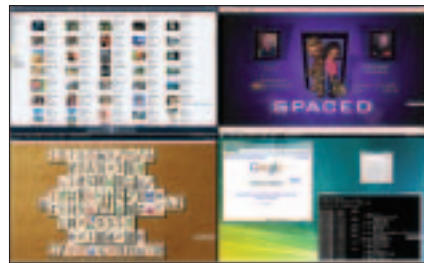


Make Vista even better

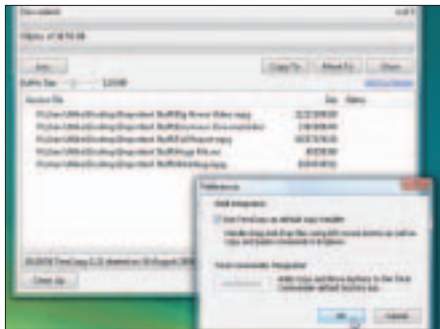
Windows isn't perfect and some of its failings are easier to spot than others. We examine Vista's flaws and how you can get around them with the help of software on our CD

There's a lot to like about Windows Vista — good looks, strong security features, improved stability, effective troubleshooting tools and some excellent new applets, to name but a few examples. But let's be realistic; as with previous versions of Microsoft's operating system, Vista is not without its faults.

Spend some time with Vista and you'll begin to spot the hidden flaws, the technical issues that really need to be addressed, and the areas in which the operating system still compares unfavourably with rivals such as Linux or Leopard (Mac OS X). That sounds a little depressing, but it's only the start. Once you've identified the weaknesses in Windows it becomes much easier to patch them up with third-

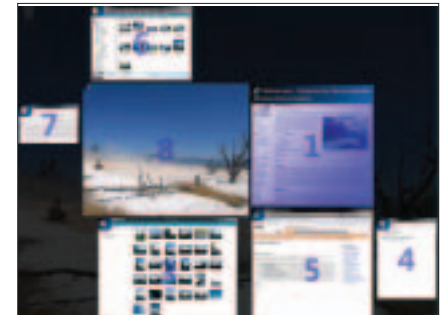


Why cram all your applications onto just one desktop? Dexpot gives you up to four, and you can switch between them with a simple mouse click



Enjoy faster file copying with a little help from a third-party add-on such as Teracopy

party tools and so deliver a faster, more efficient and productive PC — often for little or no extra cost. In this feature we'll show you how to compensate for Vista's shortcomings using free software that you'll find on our cover CD.



Poor performance

The most common complaint about Windows Vista is that it's a poor performer.

There's some truth in this, but in part it's because the operating system is doing more than ever before. It takes lots of memory and system resources to run the stylish Aero interface, for instance, and this may have a noticeable effect on older PCs and notebook PCs.

Still, if your system seems sluggish then you can always turn Aero off. Simply right-click the Desktop, click Personalise > Window Colour and Appearance > Open Classic Appearance Properties... and choose Windows Vista Basic in the Colour Scheme box. There are many other performance-related settings that need to be carefully checked to ensure your system is running at its best.

Replacing Windows' tools with third-party add-ons can help, too. Some users report that copying files seems slow with Windows Vista, for instance, but we have found Teracopy (www.codesector.com/teracopy.php) can often move data more quickly.

If you find searches in Windows Vista are not as fast as you'd like, try Copernic (www.copernic.com). It locates files in a flash, and uses minimal system resources so won't interfere with other programs.

The ultimate performance tool is Vlite (www.vlite.net), which builds a custom Windows Vista installation that includes only the components you need. It can deliver great results, but beware — it may also cause problems of its own if you accidentally remove something important. This is one for Windows experts only.

Forget Vista's Flip3D browser, Switcher is the easiest way to switch between all the applications you have open on your PC